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Project Feasibility Calculator — User guide

For everyone at CPL Aromas who submits, approves, administers or audits fragrance project briefs. (Version 1.0, November 2026.)

What is this?

The Project Feasibility Calculator replaces the old Excel workbook. You enter the facts about a customer's brief; the calculator scores it, tells you whether it can go ahead commercially, works out which colleagues must sign off resources, and issues an **Approval Code** once everything is cleared. Every step is recorded so it can be checked later.

Which guide is for me?

If you…	Read
submit briefs (Account Manager, Sales Coordinator)	Account Managers and Sales Coordinators
are asked to approve resources (Jo Lambert, Selena Wagstaff, Claire Holland …)	Approvers
are the General Manager (veto)	Approvers, section "The General Manager's veto"
look after people, roles and scoring rules (Admins)	Admins
need to check a brief or a code after the fact (Auditors, Admins)	Auditors
just want the one-page summary	Quick reference

The idea in one minute

```
Submit brief ⟶ Score and commercial decision ⟶ Resource sign-offs
⟶ Approval Code
 (you)           (automatic, instant)               (approvers)
(when all clear)
```

1. **Commercial decision** (automatic). The score decides one of three outcomes: **Auto-approved**, **Pending** or **Declined**. (Rework of a selling fragrance, or a niche/fine-fragrance pre-approval, is always auto-approved.)
2. **Sign-offs** (people). Independently of the commercial decision, a brief can need approval from named colleagues, for example for a short deadline, a creative approach, or a PPD, GCMS or marketing resource. A brief can be *commercially* auto-approved and still be waiting for a sign-off. The screen always shows both.

3. **Approval Code.** When every sign-off is cleared (and the brief isn't declined) the brief is **Approved** and receives a code like `FC-2609-4X7K2-B`. No code, no go-ahead.

Signing in

Open the address CPL IT gives you and choose **Sign in with Microsoft**, using your CPL account. What you see depends on the roles an Admin has given you. If you sign in and see very little, you probably have no role yet. Ask an Admin (see the Admin guide). Role changes take effect **the next time you sign in**, so sign out and in again after one.

Roles at a glance

Role	Can do
Account Manager / **Sales Coordinator**	Submit briefs; see their own briefs and outcomes. (Currently the two roles behave identically in the screens.)
Approver (plus one or more approval roles)	Approve or reject the sign-offs assigned to their role.
General Manager (veto)	See every brief; veto any open sign-off.
Auditor	Read-only access to all briefs, decisions, audit trail and the dashboard.
Admin	Everything an Auditor sees, plus people and roles, scoring rules and veto reversals. Cannot submit briefs.

The sign-offs and who holds them (CPL's current setup):

Sign-off	Raised when	Approved by
Short deadline	The deadline is 14 days or fewer away (the short-deadline window)	Development Director (Jo Lambert)
Creative approach (creation / starting point)	Creation/Unknown for tiers other than A and T; Starting Point for tiers C and D	Development Director (Jo Lambert)
Marketing resource	The brief needs marketing resource	Divisional Head, Marketing (Selena Wagstaff)
PPD resource	The brief needs PPD resource	PPD Manager (Jo Lambert)
GCMS / analytical resource	The brief needs GCMS	Analytical Manager (Jo Lambert)
Tier T (Target account)	The brief's tier is T (once Tier T is switched on)	Commercial Director (Claire Holland)

Admins can change who holds each role. Pauline Holmes (General Manager) may veto any open sign-off but is not asked to approve any.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Brief	A customer's request for a fragrance project, as entered here.
Score	A number calculated from the brief's facts using the current rule set.
Commercial decision	Auto-approved, Pending or Declined, from the score and a few exceptions.
Requirement / sign-off	A named colleague must approve something (a resource, a deadline).
Approval Code	The reference issued when a brief is fully cleared.
Rule set	The scoring weights, thresholds and routing table. Versioned; the version used is recorded on every brief.
Pre-approval	A submitter declares a manager has already agreed a sign-off (see the Account Manager guide). The manager can revoke it for 72 hours.
Escalated	A sign-off that would go to the submitter themselves goes to an Admin instead.
Veto	The General Manager blocks an open sign-off and declines the brief until an Admin reverses it.

Getting help

Questions about a brief, a score or who should approve: ask an Admin (Simon Roper, Tia O'Neil or Alfred Muthunathan). Technical problems (can't sign in, page errors): CPL IT. # Guide for Account Managers and Sales Coordinators

You submit briefs and follow them through to an Approval Code.

> Who can submit: people with the **Account Manager** or **Sales Coordinator** role. If you don't see a **New brief** button on your home page, ask an Admin to add the role.

1. Your home page

After signing in, **Your briefs** shows the 10 briefs you most recently submitted with their score, status and Approval Code (once issued). Click a customer reference to open the brief. The left-hand menu has **Briefs** (search everything you can see) and, for people who also approve, **Approvals**.

2. Submitting a brief

Click **New brief**. The form has three steps.

Step 1 — Brief details

Field	What to enter
Customer reference	The customer's name or your reference for the opportunity. You will search by this later.

Field	What to enter
Customer tier	A, B, C, D, or T (Target account), as defined by CPL's rules. The list comes from the live rule set.
Value potential (£)	Expected annual value in pounds. Zero makes every value-based score component zero.
New / Rework	New; Rework (Of Selling); or Rework (Non-Selling).
Brief type	Exclusive, Competitive or ProActive.
Customer approval	Direct, or Deferred/Unknown.
Creative approach	Library Only, Starting Point, or Creation/Unknown.
Deadline	The customer's deadline. It must be in the future.
PV reference	Optional project-vault reference.
Niche / Fine Fragrance pre-approved	Tick only if it genuinely is. A **rationale is required**. This makes the brief commercially Auto-approved.
Strategic priority	Tick if it is a strategic priority. A **rationale is required**. It adds to the score.
Resources	Tick **Marketing**, **PPD** and/or **GCMS** if the project needs them. Each one always needs a sign-off.

Click **Next: Approvals**.

Step 2 — Approvals (the live preview)

You now see, before you commit to anything:

- the **score** and the **commercial decision** (Auto-approved, Pending or Declined),
- a bar for each part of the score, so you can see what is driving it,
- **Will require approval from**: every sign-off this brief raises and who gives it.

If something surprises you, press **Back** and check your answers. This is the best time to spot a wrong tier or a mistyped value.

Pre-approval (optional). If a manager has *already* agreed a sign-off with you (for example, Jo Lambert has told you the short deadline is fine), you can declare it:

1. Tick the pre-approval box under that sign-off.
2. Choose the **manager** from the list of people who hold that role.
3. Write a **comment** saying what was agreed.

The brief proceeds as if that sign-off were cleared, and the manager you named receives an email with a one-time **revoke link**. If they do nothing, the pre-approval stands. They have **72 hours** to revoke; revoking returns the sign-off to the queue and **withdraws any Approval Code** already issued. Use pre-approval only when the conversation really happened: it is recorded under your name, and CPL reports on how often it is used and revoked.

Step 3 — Review & submit

Check the summary, then **Submit brief**. You are taken to the result.

3. What happens next

The brief's status is one of:

Status	Meaning	What you do
Approved	Commercially OK and every sign-off cleared. The **Approval Code** is shown.	Quote the code; you can go ahead.
Pending	Waiting on the commercial decision and/or one or more sign-offs.	Wait. **Approvers are not emailed automatically** when a sign-off is raised, so tell them (the brief page shows which role each sign-off is waiting on) and check back on the brief.
Declined	Commercially declined, or vetoed by the General Manager.	Do not proceed. See the brief for the reason. A new brief can be raised if the facts change.

Important: a brief can show **commercially Auto-approved** while still **Pending** because a sign-off is outstanding. There is no Approval Code until all sign-offs clear.

There is **no email when your brief is approved**. Open the brief (or **Your briefs**) to see the status and the Approval Code. You **are** emailed when a pre-approval you declared is revoked, when a brief of yours is vetoed by the General Manager, and when such a veto is reversed. Emails come from the Feasibility Calculator mailbox and can arrive up to about five minutes after the event.

4. Finding and checking a brief

- **Briefs** (left menu) lets you search by customer or PV reference, and filter by status and tier.

- Click a brief to see its inputs, score breakdown, commercial decision, the sign-offs and who decided each (with their comments), and the Approval Code.
- You see **your own briefs** (and, if you are also an approver, briefs with a sign-off for your role). You do not see the audit trail; Admins and Auditors do.

5. Common questions

Can I edit a brief after submitting? No. A submitted brief is a record. If a fact was wrong, submit a new brief (and tell the approvers so they ignore the earlier one).

Why was my brief declined? A score at or below the decline threshold (currently 30) is declined. The breakdown on the brief shows what pulled it down. Competitive briefs and non-selling rework contribute nothing to value-based parts of the score; ProActive subtracts.

Why does an A-tier brief not need approval but a T-tier one does? Tier T is a Target account: by CPL's rule it always goes to the Commercial Director (once Tier T has been switched on).

The approver is on leave. Tell an Admin; they can add a second holder to the role.

I submitted something I shouldn't have. Contact an Admin straight away; nothing can be deleted, but the people who need to know can be told and a veto can stop it. # Guide for Approvers

You are asked to approve or reject the sign-offs routed to your role, for example PPD resource, marketing resource, a short deadline, a creative approach, or a Tier T brief. If you are the General Manager, see "The General Manager's veto" at the end.

> You need the **Approver** access role plus the specific approval role (for example PPD Manager). Without both you see nothing to approve. Ask an Admin if something is missing.

1. Being asked

The app does not currently email you when a sign-off is raised for your role. Open **Approvals** in the left menu regularly (the submitter may also tell you). The only email the app sends an approver is the one in section 4, when a pre-approval is declared in your name. Notifying approvers of new sign-offs is on the backlog.

2. Your approvals page

Approvals lists everything waiting for you, grouped by sign-off type. Each item shows the customer, tier and value, the score, and the commercial position ("commercially Auto-approved / Pending / Declined").

For each item you can:

- **Approve**. Optionally add a comment.
- **Reject**. A **comment is mandatory** and should say why: it is shown to the submitter on the brief.

When several items of the same type are waiting, tick the ones you want and press **Approve selected** to approve them in one go. (Bulk action approves only; reject items one at a time with a comment.) Open the customer reference first if you want the full brief: inputs, score breakdown and the other sign-offs.

3. What your decision does

- **Approve:** the sign-off is cleared. When it was the last one outstanding, and the brief isn't commercially declined, the brief becomes **Approved** and the Approval Code is issued. The submitter is **not** emailed; they see it on the brief.
- **Reject:** the sign-off is marked rejected with your comment. A rejected sign-off does not clear the brief, so it stays without an Approval Code. (Talk to the submitter; if the brief should be stopped outright, ask the General Manager or an Admin.)

Decisions can't be undone from the Approvals page. If you made a mistake, tell an Admin.

4. If you are named as a pre-approving manager

A submitter can declare that you already agreed a sign-off. You get an email titled *Pre-approval declared on your behalf*, with the submitter's comment and a **revoke link**.

- If it's correct, **do nothing**. After the window (72 hours) it stands.
- If it's **not** correct, open the link and press **Yes, revoke this pre-approval**. The link works **once**. The sign-off returns to the queue and any Approval Code already issued for that brief is withdrawn. The submitter is told.

5. Things you cannot do, by design

- Approve a sign-off that isn't routed to your role.
- Approve a brief **you submitted** or one submitted for you as Account Manager. If every holder of a role is in that position, the sign-off is **escalated to an Admin** and recorded as such.

6. The General Manager's veto

If you hold the **General Manager (veto)** role (Pauline Holmes):

- You can see **every brief** (not the audit trail).
- Nothing is ever routed to you, so nothing waits on you.
- On the **Approvals** page, under **Veto**, you see every sign-off that is still open on any brief, whoever it is routed to. Type a **reason** (required) and press **Veto**.

A veto:

1. marks that sign-off rejected with your reason,
2. **declines the brief** (any Approval Code is withdrawn, and no one can approve the brief's remaining sign-offs),
3. emails the submitter, and
4. is recorded in the audit trail with your name.

Only an **Admin** can reverse a veto, and they must give a reason. Reversal returns the sign-off to the approver's queue and the brief to Pending. Use the veto for genuine reasons (capacity, a conflict with strategy), not as a routine step: it is visible to everyone who can see the brief. # Guide for Admins

Admins look after **people and roles**, the **scoring rules**, **escalated sign-offs** and **vetoes**. It is a deliberately small group (currently Alfred Muthunathan, Simon Roper and Tia O'Neil). Admins can see every brief, the audit trail and the dashboard, but **cannot submit briefs** unless they are also given the Account Manager role.

Your menu: **Briefs**, **Approvals**, **Dashboard**, **Rule sets**, **People and roles**, **Verify a code**.

1. People and roles

Open **People and roles**. Every person is listed with their roles, whether they have signed in yet, and whether they are active.

Add a person. Enter their **name** and **work email** (their Microsoft sign-in address) and press **Add person**. They have no access until you give them a role. When they first sign in with Microsoft, their account is matched to this entry by email address (capitals don't matter).

Give a role. In their row, choose a role from **Add a role** and press **Add**. Roles are of two kinds:

Kind	Roles	Purpose
Access roles	Account Manager, Sales Coordinator, Approver, Auditor, Admin	What the person can do in the app.
Approval roles	PPD Manager, Analytical Manager, Development Director, Divisional Head of Marketing, Commercial Director, General Manager (veto)	Which sign-offs they handle.

An **approver needs both**: the *Approver* access role **and** the specific approval role(s). Someone can hold several (Jo Lambert holds Approver, Development Director, PPD Manager and Analytical Manager).

End a role. Press the **×** on the role. It ends immediately for new sign-ins, and the history is kept.

Deactivate / Reactivate. Use this when someone leaves. A deactivated person cannot sign in. Their past decisions stay in the record.

Rules the screen enforces:

- You cannot remove or deactivate the **last active Admin**.
- A role can't be given twice.
- Every change is written to the **audit trail**.

Role changes apply when the person next signs in. They are fixed at sign-in, so someone already signed in keeps their old roles until they sign out and in again (and

a deactivated person who is already signed in stays signed in until their session ends). For urgent removals, also ask CPL IT to disable the person's Microsoft account.

Cover for leave. Roles can have more than one holder. Add the second person to the same approval role. A sign-off goes to the role, so any holder can decide it.

2. Scoring rules (Rule sets)

The score, the thresholds and the routing table live in a versioned **rule set**. Only Admins can change them.

- A **published** rule set is **immutable** and is the one used for every new brief. Every brief records which version scored it.
- To change anything you create a **new draft**, edit it, **replay** it, then **publish**.

Workflow

1. **Rule sets → New draft.** The draft starts as a copy of the published set.
2. Edit: **tier weights**, the **auto-approve and decline thresholds**, the **multipliers and scores** (new/rework, brief type, customer approval, creative approach), the **strategic priority bonus**, the **short deadline window (days)**, and the **routing table** (which role approves each sign-off, and whether it is enabled).
3. **Save draft.**
4. **Run replay.** Every past brief is re-scored with the draft, and you are shown how many commercial decisions would change, grouped by move (for example "declined → pending: 7"), with the briefs listed. **Read this before publishing:** it tells you what the change really does.
5. **Publish.** Publishing is only offered after a replay of the *current saved* draft. It replaces the previous rule set (which is kept for history). Past briefs keep their original decision; only new briefs use the new rules.

Current settings (v1): auto-approve above **115**, decline at or below **30**, short-deadline window **14 days**.

Adding Tier T. Tier T (Target account: always Commercial Director approval) is a separate tier from A. The tier list itself cannot be edited on screen. CPL IT runs a one-off job that creates a draft with Tier T added (deployment guide, section 10); you then replay and publish it like any other draft. The Tier T weight is assumed to be **100** (same as A): confirm or change it in the draft before publishing.

3. Escalated sign-offs

If the only people who hold an approval role are the person who submitted the brief (or the Account Manager it was submitted for), they cannot approve their own brief. The sign-off is **escalated to Admin**: it appears in **Approvals** with an *Escalated to Admin* tag and the reason, and the event is in the audit trail. Approve or reject it as you would any other. (You never see escalated items for briefs you submitted yourself.)

If a sign-off has **no holder at all** it is not escalated; it just waits. Fix it by giving someone the role.

4. Vetoes

When the General Manager vetoes a brief, the brief page shows a red **Vetoed by the General Manager** box with the name, time and reason. Only an Admin can reverse it:

1. Open the brief (**Briefs** → customer).
2. Type a **reason for reversing** (required) and press **Reverse veto**.

The vetoed sign-off returns to the approver's queue, the brief goes back to **Pending**, the submitter is emailed, and both the veto and its reversal stay in the audit trail.

5. Looking things up

- **Briefs:** every brief, searchable by customer or PV reference, filterable by status and tier. Opening one shows the full **audit trail** (submission, each decision, escalations, vetoes, role-related events).
- **Dashboard:** volumes and outcomes by month, approval rates and decision times by role, score distribution, pre-approval usage by submitter (and how many were revoked), and short-deadline volume.
- **Verify a code:** paste an Approval Code to open the brief it belongs to.

6. Housekeeping checklist

When	What
Someone joins	Add them, give roles, tell them to sign in.
Someone leaves	Deactivate them; reassign any approval role they alone held.
Someone is on leave	Add a second holder to their approval role.
Rules change	New draft → replay → publish; tell approvers and submitters.
Each quarter	Review who holds Admin and each approval role. Check the dashboard for roles with slow decisions.

7. Things to know

- Nothing is ever deleted. Briefs, decisions and audit events are a permanent record.
- **Emails:** the app emails only for pre-approval declared/revoked, vetoes and veto reversals. It does **not** email approvers when a sign-off is raised: remind them to check **Approvals**, or consider asking for that feature.
- Technical problems (sign-in failures, errors, missing emails): contact CPL IT. # Guide for Auditors

Auditors have **read-only** access to everything: every brief, every decision, the full audit trail and the dashboard. Nothing you do here changes any data.

Your menu: **Briefs**, **Dashboard**, **Verify a code**.

1. Look up a brief from an Approval Code

Someone quotes a code (for example `FC-2609-4X7K2-B`). Open **Verify a code**, paste it and press verify. You are shown the brief it belongs to, the **rule set version** that scored it, the score, the commercial decision and the sign-offs. If the code is unknown or was withdrawn (for example after a revoked pre-approval or a veto) you are told so. A code that is withdrawn means the brief is **not** approved.

2. Search for briefs

Briefs lists every brief. Search by customer reference or PV reference, filter by **status** (Pending, Approved, Declined) and **tier**, and page through. Each row shows the score, commercial decision, how many sign-offs are still outstanding, and the Approval Code if issued.

3. Read a brief and its audit trail

Open a brief to see:

- the **inputs** exactly as submitted, and who submitted it (and on whose behalf),
- the **score breakdown**, component by component, and the **rule set version**,
- each **sign-off**: which role, its state (Pending, Approved, Rejected, Pre-approved, Revoked), who decided it, when, and their comment,
- any **veto** (who, when, why) and any pre-approval declaration,
- the **audit trail**: a time-ordered list of events (for example `brief.submitted`, `requirement.approved`, `requirement.escalated_to_admin`, `brief.vetoed`, `brief.veto_reversed`).

The audit trail is **append-only**: the database prevents any event from being edited or deleted.

4. Dashboard

Overview of volumes and outcomes by month, approval rate and time-to-decision by role, the score distribution, how often pre-approval is used (and revoked) by submitter, and short-deadline volume. Use it to spot bottlenecks and unusual behaviour, for example one submitter pre-approving a lot, or a role with a long median time to decide.

5. Questions an audit might ask, and where to look

Question	Where
Was this brief properly approved?	**Verify a code** → check each sign-off is Approved or Pre-approved and the code is present.
Which rules scored it?	Brief page → rule set version (versions are immutable).
Who approved it, and did they have the right role?	Brief page → sign-off decided by; roles are in the audit trail and with an Admin.
Did anyone approve their own brief?	Not possible: such sign-offs are escalated to an Admin and logged (`requirement.escalated_to_admin`).

Question	Where
Was a sign-off overridden?	Look for pre-approval declarations, revocations, vetoes and reversals on the brief and in the trail.
Has anyone changed who holds a role?	An Admin can show role changes (`user.*` and `role.*` events).

6. Limits

- Auditors can't see the people list or change anything.
- There is no export yet; the data is in the database, and CPL IT can run a query on request. # Quick reference

Which button, which role

I want to…	Where	Role needed
Submit a brief	Home → **New brief**	Account Manager / Sales Coordinator
See my briefs / search	**Briefs**	anyone signed in (you see what your role allows)
Approve or reject a sign-off	**Approvals**	Approver + the approval role
Veto a sign-off	**Approvals → Veto**	General Manager (veto)
Reverse a veto	Brief page → **Reverse veto**	Admin
Add a person or change roles	**People and roles**	Admin
Change scoring rules	**Rule sets**	Admin
Look up a code	**Verify a code**	Auditor or Admin
See trends	**Dashboard**	Auditor or Admin

The outcome, in order

1. **Score and commercial decision** (instant): Auto-approved / Pending / Declined.
   - Declined: score at or below **30**. Auto-approved: above **115**. In between: Pending.
   - Always Auto-approved: *Rework (Of Selling)* and *Niche/Fine Fragrance pre-approved*.
2. **Sign-offs** (people), raised independently of the commercial decision:

Sign-off	Raised when	Role
Short deadline	Deadline 14 days or fewer away	Development Director
Creative (creation)	Creation/Unknown, tier not A or T	Development Director
Creative (starting point)	Starting Point, tier C or D	Development Director
Marketing /	The box is ticked	Divisional Head Marketing / PPD Manager /

Sign-off	Raised when	Role
PPD / GCMS		Analytical Manager
Tier T	Tier T (when enabled)	Commercial Director

3. **Approval Code** when all sign-offs are Approved or Pre-approved and the brief isn't declined.

Rules of the road

- A brief can be *commercially Auto-approved* and still **Pending**: no code until every sign-off clears.
- Rejecting needs a comment. A veto needs a reason. Reversing a veto needs a reason.
- Pre-approval: the named manager has **72 hours** to revoke, once, from the email link.
- You can't approve a brief you submitted; those sign-offs go to an Admin.
- Role changes apply the **next time you sign in**.
- Nothing is ever deleted. Everything is in the audit trail.

Emails the app sends

Pre-approval declared (to the named manager) · Pre-approval revoked (to the submitter) · Brief vetoed (to the submitter) · Veto reversed (to the submitter). Not sent: "sign-off needed" to approvers; "approved" to submitters. Check **Approvals** / the brief.